

Write a Story or Description From the Title Given

You choose the genre and approach. The title must guide everything you write — nothing should feel bolted on.

Name: _____ Date set: _____ Due: _____

YOUR TITLE

"Nobody Noticed the Second Time"

Write a story OR a description inspired by this title. It does not have to appear as a line in your writing, but every reader should be able to see exactly why you chose it once they finish.

This is harder than it looks. A weak answer bolts the title onto a generic story at the last line. A strong answer builds the whole piece — structure, pacing, even the ending — around what the title actually implies: that something happened once already, unnoticed, and now it's happening again.

BEFORE YOU START — PLAN YOUR INTERPRETATION

1. What is "the second time" — the second time what happens? Decide this before writing a single sentence.
2. Who is the "nobody" — is it genuinely nobody, or is there one person who half-notices and dismisses it? That tension is often the strongest angle.
3. Will your reader find out what the "first time" was, or is it left as implication? Both are valid — pick one deliberately.

YOUR WRITING

Checklist — go over it again

1. **Could someone who hasn't seen the title guess it from your ending?** If not, the piece isn't built around it tightly enough yet.
2. Clear beginning → build → ending shape, and your final sentence connects back to the title without repeating its words.
3. At least 2 pieces of figurative language that fit the mood, and a mix of long and short sentences used deliberately.
4. Check every character's motivation makes sense — nobody acts a certain way "because the plot needed it."
5. No clichéd openings ("It was a dark and stormy night," "Little did I know").
6. Punctuation check: commas around interrupting phrases, correct use of ellipsis (not overused for suspense).